Hanqi Liu

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Education

PhD, Economics, University of Calgary *2021-2027 (Expected)*
MA, Economics, The University of Texas at Austin *2019-2020*
BA, Economics, Huazhong Agricultural University *2015-2019*
Exchange student, University of California, San Diego *Fall 2018*

References

M. Scott Taylor
Professor of Economics
University of Calgary
mstaylor@ucalgary.ca
Ph.D. Supervisor

Jean-William P. Laliberté
Associate Professor of Economics
University of Calgary
jeanwilliam.lalibert@ucalgary.ca
Thesis Committee Member

Arvind Magesan
Professor of Economics
University of Calgary
anmagesa@ucalgary.ca
Thesis Committee Member

Research Fields

International Trade, Labor Economics, Environmental Economics

Working Papers

The China Shock's Surprising Impact on Intergenerational Income Mobility (Job Market Paper)
Under review

The Impact of Trade Liberalization on School Enrolment: Evidence from China
Conditionally accepted, Canadian Journal of Economics

Hit Them Where It Hurts: Strategically Chosen Tariffs in a Supply Chain World

Work in Progress

The Environmental Echo of the China Shock: Trade and Environmental Policy in a Strategic World

Research Experience

Research Assistant to M. Scott Taylor *2022-Present*

Research assistance on environmental economics and international trade, covering biodiversity and extinction, trade and renewable resource use, carbon taxation in maritime shipping, and the effects of shipping noise on marine mammals.

Teaching Experience

Sessional Instructor

Intermediate Economic Theory - Microeconomics (Econ 301) *Spring 2025*

Teaching Assistant

Intermediate Economic Theory - Microeconomics (Econ 301); Engineering Economics (Econ 209); Monetary Theory (Econ 541); Behavioral Economics (Econ 481) *2021-2025*

Scholarships & Awards

University of Calgary

Faculty of Graduate Studies Doctoral Scholarship	*2025*
Eyes High International Doctoral Scholarship	*2023, 2024*
Alberta Graduate Excellence Scholarship	*2023*
Econometrics Prize (highest average in required PhD Econometrics courses)	*2022*
International Graduate Tuition Award	*2021-Present*

Huazhong Agricultural University

Merit Student (top 10% of economics department, awarded annually)	*2015-2019*

Presentations (Including Scheduled)

Canadian Economics Association (CEA) Annual Conference	*2024, 2025, 2026*
Graduate Poster Presentation, CEA Annual Conference	*2024, 2026*
Canadian International Trade Study Group Conference	*2024*
UC Berkeley/Sloan Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics	*2024*
University of Calgary Internal Seminar	*2024, 2025, 2026*
Rocky Mountain Empirical Trade Conference (Discussant)	*2024, 2026*

Languages & Skills

Languages: English (fluent), Chinese (native)

Software: Python, Stata, LaTeX, R, Microsoft Office

Abstracts

The China Shock's Surprising Impact on Intergenerational Income Mobility (Job Market Paper)
Under review

Import competition is known to hurt manufacturing workers, but its effects on their children have been largely overlooked. These effects determine whether a trade shock ends with one generation or reaches the next, shaping how much a child's prospects depend on family background. When the China Shock hit Canadian manufacturing, did family background matter more? Poorer families have little to draw on, while richer ones can insulate their children. Using matched employer-employee data that link children to their parents, I find the opposite: the shock raises intergenerational income mobility. In the hardest-hit families, where a child ends up depends about 20% less on where their parents stood. Children from poorer families climb the economic ladder; they escape by moving out of their parents' industries into ones where family background matters less and pay is about as good. Children from richer families fall; they stood to follow their parents into high-paying manufacturing industries, and the shock takes those jobs away.

The Impact of Trade Liberalization on School Enrolment: Evidence from China
Conditionally accepted, Canadian Journal of Economics

This paper exploits quasi-experimental variation in local exposure to the shock of China's accession to the World Trade Organization (WTO) to evaluate its impact on high school enrolment, a key margin along which human capital accumulates. I construct a measure of prefecture-level trade exposure using initial industrial composition, industry-level tariff reductions, and spatially determined geographic trade costs, and I estimate both the short- and long-run impact of the shock on enrolment. Using detailed population census data on successive cohorts of 16-year-olds from 1995 to 2014, I find that a one-standard-deviation increase in exposure reduces high school enrolment by 8% relative to the baseline rate of the last pre-accession cohort. Surprisingly, this drop in enrolment persists and even grows across successive cohorts. These results suggest that China's WTO accession created an export-driven labour demand shock biased toward low-skilled workers and reinforced by subsequent complementary investment.

Hit Them Where It Hurts: Strategically Chosen Tariffs in a Supply Chain World

Production today is split into sequential stages located in different countries. A tariff on one input therefore moves the prices of the goods made from it downstream and of the inputs used to make it upstream, and part of its effect returns to the country that imposed it. Where along a supply chain should a country levy a tariff, and how high should it be? I develop a two-country model of sequential production in which the government chooses both. The optimal tariff at a given stage extends the classic inverse-elasticity rule with two new forces. The first, a re-export rent borne by foreign buyers of downstream output, raises it. The second, a cost boomerang, is the domestic value that returns through the price of the taxed import. A tariff on final goods forgoes the re-export rent entirely, so taxing further upstream can raise welfare by more.